

BUSINESS PLAN

FOR STARTUP

EduNeuro

AI-Native Study Orchestration and Learning Platform

Submission to IIT Guwahati Technology Incubation Centre (TIC)

Founder:Sumanta

Entity:EduNeuro

Stage:Open Beta / Pre-Incubation

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Classification:Confidential

This document is submitted in connection with EduNeuro's application for incubation support at IIT Guwahati Technology Incubation Centre. All information contained herein is confidential and intended solely for evaluating the venture.

1. Startup Overview

EduNeuro is an early-stage technology startup developing an AI-native study orchestration and learning platform. The venture was founded by Sumanta, a student researcher in Artificial Intelligence, with the objective of applying AI systems thinking to a systemic problem in education technology: the fragmentation of the student learning journey.

- **Venture:** EduNeuro
- **Founder:** Sumanta
- **Founder background:** Student researcher, Artificial Intelligence
- **Stage:** Open Beta / Pre-Incubation
- **Target incubator:** IIT Guwahati Technology Incubation Centre (TIC)
- **Initial market:** GATE examination preparation (Graduate Aptitude Test in Engineering)

The venture is self-funded at the founder level with no external investment to date. Development has proceeded through an open beta phase to validate core assumptions and gather early user feedback.

2. Founder

Sumanta is a student researcher working in Artificial Intelligence. The founding perspective combines:

- Technical depth in AI systems and machine learning, providing the ability to evaluate and implement AI-driven product architectures.
- Direct experience with examination preparation, providing first-hand understanding of the problem space and target user needs.
- Research orientation, enabling rigorous experimentation with learning models, evaluation frameworks, and AI product design.

The founder is the primary operator at this stage. Plans to strengthen the team — including technical co-lead capability, content development resources, and community management — are contingent on incubation admission and progress towards product-market validation.

3. Problem

A student preparing for a competitive examination such as GATE typically uses five or more separate digital tools: video platforms for concept learning, question banks for practice, a study planner, a productivity/focus app, and increasingly, an AI chatbot for doubt resolution.

These tools are optimised for individual activities, not for the student's entire learning process. They do not share information. They do not understand the student as an individual. And they leave the student to answer the most difficult questions alone:

- What should I study next?
- Which of my weak areas need the most attention?
- Am I actually improving, or just staying busy?
- How does my study behaviour affect my outcomes?

- When should I revise what I have already learned?
- Is my study plan working, or should I change it?

These are not content problems. They are intelligence problems — the student needs a system that understands their complete learning state and can reason about their next best action.

4. Solution

EduNeuro proposes an AI-native study orchestration platform that unifies the student's fragmented toolchain around a continuous, longitudinal learner model.

The platform is designed from the ground up as an intelligent system that:

- Models the learner across multiple dimensions: knowledge state, topic mastery, performance history, study behaviour, focus quality, schedule adherence, and intervention effectiveness.
- Uses this model to determine the most valuable next learning action — whether that is learning a new concept, practising a weak area, revising spaced material, or adjusting the study plan.
- Improves its recommendations as it accumulates more data about the learner, creating a compounding personalisation effect.
- Connects every platform capability — learning, practice, planning, assessment, focus support — through the learner model, so the student experiences a coherent rather than fragmented system.

A question bank does not know your study schedule. A study planner does not know your mastery level. An AI chatbot does not know your forgetting curve. EduNeuro connects these capabilities through a shared learner intelligence layer.

5. Innovation

EduNeuro's innovation is architectural rather than incremental. It rests on three pillars:

- **Longitudinal Learner Model:** A persistent, evolving model of each learner that serves as the platform's intelligence backbone. This is distinct from tools that capture only snapshot data.
- **Proactive Orchestration:** Rather than waiting for the student to request an action, the platform actively recommends the next best step. This shifts the relationship from reactive tool to proactive guide.
- **Compound Learning Intelligence:** The system is designed to become more useful over time as it accumulates learner data. This flywheel is the intended long-term defensibility mechanism.

AI is not an add-on feature. It is the organising principle of the entire product architecture — a meaningful distinction from competitors retrofitting AI onto legacy platform structures.

6. Product

EduNeuro is a web-based platform in open beta. The table below distinguishes between current beta capabilities and planned features.

Capability	Status	Description
AI Learning Support	In development	Concept explanation and tutoring for GATE subjects

Capability	Status	Description
Study Planning	In development	Adaptive schedule generation based on exam timeline and learner state
Practice Engine	In development	Curated question practice with difficulty adaptation
Assessment	In development	Topic-wise and full-length test simulation with analytics
Progress Analytics	In development	Longitudinal tracking of mastery and behaviour
Focus Tools	Planned	Session-level focus tracking and distraction management
Personalised Recommendation	Planned	AI-driven next-action suggestions via learner model
Community Features	Planned	Peer comparison and study group functionality

'In development' indicates active build progress. 'Planned' indicates features scheduled for the incubation period.

7. Target Market

- **Primary segment (current):** GATE aspirants. Over 1 million candidates register annually across engineering disciplines. High digital literacy, high preparation intensity, willingness to invest in outcome-improving tools.
- **Secondary segments (future):** JEE, NEET, UPSC, CAT aspirants, university students, and co-curricular/extracurricular domains (music, fitness, skill development). These share the preparation-intensity profile of GATE aspirants but require domain-specific adaptation.

EduNeuro's architecture is designed to generalise across examinations, but expansion will only occur after validated product-market fit in GATE.

8. Initial Market Wedge: GATE

GATE was selected as the initial market wedge based on the following:

- **Large, defined audience:** 1M+ annual registrations across multiple engineering disciplines.
- **High stakes:** GATE scores determine admission to premier M.Tech programmes, PSU recruitment, and research positions. This creates strong motivation to adopt genuinely effective tools.
- **Structured preparation behaviour:** GATE preparation follows well-defined patterns — syllabus-based learning, topic-wise practice, mock testing, revision cycles — making it possible to build effective learner models.
- **Digital fluency:** The target demographic (engineering graduates, 21–26 years) is comfortable with digital tools and receptive to AI-augmented platforms.
- **Proving ground for generalisation:** Validating the orchestration approach for GATE provides a repeatable template for expanding to JEE, NEET, UPSC, and CAT.
- **Competitive opening:** Existing players serve this market but none has solved the orchestration thesis.

GATE is a strategically chosen proving ground, not merely a convenient starting point.

9. Technology

EduNeuro's stack is designed for scalability, AI integration, and reresponsible deployment:

- **Frontend:** Modern web framework providing responsive, accessible interfaces.
- **Backend:** Scalable service architecture handling user management, learner state persistence, content delivery, and AI service orchestration.
- **AI Layer:** Large language models for reasoning and content generation, complemented by custom algorithms for mastery tracking, spaced-repetition scheduling, and behavioural pattern analysis.
- **Data Layer:** Longitudinal learner data stored with privacy-by-design principles.
- **Infrastructure:** Cloud-hosted with auto-scaling capabilities.

AI components are being designed with reresponsible deployment in mind: content quality evaluation, learner data governance, transparency in recommendation logic, and mechanisms for learners to understand and influence the system's guidance.

10. Current Stage

Dimension	Current State
Product status	Open beta — core features in active development
Team size	1 (founder-led)
Revenue	None — zero paying users
External funding	None raised to date
User base	500+ sign-ups, 50+ DAU (recent)
Product-market fit	Not claimed — early validation only
Office space	Founder-operated remotely

The venture is self-sustaining at minimal burn. Incubation support would enable accelerated development, structured mentorship, and fundraising preparation.

11. Validation and Traction

Early-stage validation signals from the open-beta period. These are directional indicators, not evidence of product-market fit.

Current Product Validation

- 500+ user sign-ups / expressions of interest
- 50+ current DAU (recent measurement)
- ~400 peak daily users (observed during an early launch period)

Website and Content Engagement

- 505 website visitors (cumulative, early beta period)
- 3,093 page views (cumulative, early beta period)
- 126 platform responses (cumulative, early beta period)
- 200,000+ organic content reach (social media impressions)

- 150,000+ organic content views (engagement views)
- 2.6 lakh+ Instagram content views (organic)

Period-Specific Observations

- 2,565 page views over a specific 6-day period, with ~400 daily users
- 3,000+ users and 4,000+ website views over a specific 8-day period

Note: Figures marked with (+) come from different measurement periods and definitions and are presented as early validation signals only. They should not be combined into a single traction metric. EduNeuro has zero paying users and has not claimed product-market fit.

User research has been conducted through surveys administered alongside content distribution, providing qualitative insights into user pain points and feature preferences.

12. Business Model

- **Freemium Tier (Acquisition):** Free access to core study planning, basic practice, and limited AI support. Allows students to experience the platform before committing to payment.
- **Premium Subscription (Revenue):** Paid tier providing full access to advanced AI tutoring, comprehensive analytics, personalised recommendations, focus tools, and priority support. Initial monetisation is planned through a freemium/subscription model, with pricing to be validated during the early beta phase.

Current monetisation status: Zero paying users. Monetisation features are not yet active. Pricing strategy will be refined during incubation based on user research and mentor guidance.

Future monetisation opportunities — institutional licensing, B2B offerings, content partnerships — may be explored after the primary subscription model is validated.

13. Competitive Advantage

- **System-Level Integration:** Competitors optimise individual activities. EduNeuro connects them through a shared learner model.
- **Longitudinal Intelligence:** The platform's value compounds over time as it accumulates learner data. This is the intended flywheel (not yet realised at scale).
- **Exam-First Depth:** Deep GATE focus enables domain-specific intelligence that generalist tools lack.
- **AI-Native Architecture:** Every component is designed around AI-driven reasoning rather than passive content delivery.
- **Research-Led Development:** The founder's background enables rigorous experimentation with learning models and AI techniques.

14. Go-to-Market Strategy

- **Content-Driven Acquisition:** Publishing educational content on platforms where GATE aspirants are active. Early organic reach of 200,000+ validates this channel.
- **Community Trust Building:** Authentic engagement within GATE preparation communities to build trust rather than relying on promotional messaging.

- **Product-Led Virality:** Sharing mechanisms (study plan exports, performance summaries) that naturally expose the platform to new users.
- **Freemium Conversion:** Free tier as the primary conversion funnel.
- **Institutional Outreach (Phase 2):** Once product-market fit is demonstrated, engaging coaching institutions and engineering colleges.

Paid advertising is not part of the current strategy and will only be evaluated after organic channels are validated at scale.

15. Development Roadmap

Phase	Duration	Focus	Key Outcomes
Beta Foundation	M1–3	Core platform, GATE syllabus, AI tutoring MVP	Functional platform, initial learner model, 200+ beta users
Beta Expansion	M4–6	Practice engine, assessment, analytics	Complete learning loop, retention metrics, user research
Beta Maturation	M7–9	Recommendations, focus tools, longitudinal inference	Personalisation engine, freemium infrastructure, retention
Launch Readiness	M10–12	Full feature suite, paid tier, community	Paid tier activated, 1,000+ total users, monetisation validation
Scale Preparation	M12–18	Infrastructure scaling, multi-branch support	Multi-GATE-branch support, pre-seed fundraising preparation

Timelines are indicative. Future phases are targets, not commitments.

16. Scalability

- **User scalability:** Cloud-native infrastructure with auto-scaling to handle growing loads without proportional cost increases.
- **Content scalability:** AI-assisted content generation and curation that can extend across GATE branches and subsequently other syllabi without linear increases in human content effort.
- **Examination scalability:** The learner model and orchestration engine are designed as general-purpose components. Expanding to a new examination primarily requires syllabus mapping and content curation.

The economics of the platform improve with scale. AI infrastructure costs grow sub-linearly with user volume due to caching and model efficiency. Content development costs are front-loaded and amortised across users. Subscription revenue is recurring. Long-term scalability to millions of users is contingent on successful validation in the initial GATE wedge.

17. Social and Economic Impact

- Democratising access to AI-powered personalised learning for students who cannot afford expensive one-on-one coaching.
- Reducing the cognitive load of meta-cognitive decision-making — deciding what to study next — freeing mental energy for actual learning.
- Making quality preparation support accessible in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.

- Contributing to educational research through responsible deployment and transparent evaluation of learning outcomes.
- Improved GATE outcomes translate into better postgraduate education and employment opportunities, contributing to economic mobility.

18. Incubation Requirements

- **Physical workspace:** Co-working space at IIT Guwahati TIC (12–18 months).
- **Mentorship:** Access to mentors in AI/ML, edtech, product management, and startup operations. Specific areas detailed in the Mentorship Form.
- **Seed funding:** Pre-seed funding, details to be discussed with TIC.
- **Technical resources:** Computing infrastructure, research collaboration, student researcher engagement.
- **Ecosystem access:** Investor introductions, industry partners, and startup network access.
- **Programme structure:** TIC's incubation curriculum, workshops, pitch sessions, and milestone reviews.
- **Credibility:** Association with IIT Guwahati's brand for customer trust and investor introductions.

19. Funding Requirements

- **Incubation funding:** Pre-seed funding to cover development, cloud infrastructure, AI API costs, and essential operations for 12–18 months.
- **Post-incubation pre-seed/seed:** Target raise to be determined during incubation, contingent on achieving milestones. Timing: Month 12–15.
- **Use of funds:** Team expansion, marketing acceleration, infrastructure scaling, and multi-examination expansion preparation.
- **Target investors:** Angel networks, micro-VCs, and edtech-focused funds.

Funding amounts will be refined during incubation with mentor guidance, based on validated unit economics and detailed financial projections.

20. Key Milestones

Milestone	Timeline	Status
Open beta launch	Completed	Achieved
500+ sign-ups	Completed	Achieved
50+ DAU	Completed	Achieved
TIC incubation admission	Q4 2026	Planned
Complete feature beta	Month 6	Planned
1,000+ registered users	Month 9	Planned target
Paid tier activation	Month 10–12	Planned
1,000 paying users	Month 18	Planned target
Pre-seed fundraise	Month 12–15	Planned

Future milestones are projections based on current trajectory and will be refined during incubation.

21. Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation Approach
Failure to achieve product-market fit	Continuous user research, rapid iteration, mentor-guided pivot readiness
AI-generated content quality	Content validation pipelines, human review, evaluation frameworks
Prolonged development time	MVP discipline, phased releases, incubation accountability structure
Increased competitive pressure	Deep GATE-specific differentiation, system-level architecture, community trust
User acquisition cost escalation	Content-driven organic growth; paid acquisition only after organic validation
Data privacy concerns	Privacy-by-design architecture, transparent policies, compliance-first approach
Founder bandwidth limitation	Team expansion plan, task prioritisation, incubation talent network access

22. Future Expansion

EduNeuro's long-term vision extends beyond GATE. The platform's architecture is designed for eventual expansion across multiple examinations and learning contexts. Each phase is contingent on successful validation in the preceding phase.

Phase	Timeline	Focus
GATE Scale	Months 12–24	Multi-branch GATE support, community features, institutional outreach
JEE and NEET	Year 2–3	Adapt validated orchestration model for JEE Main/Advanced and NEET. Adjacent markets
UPSC, CAT, Other	Year 3–4	Expand orchestration technology to UPSC CSE, CAT/XAT, and other competitive exams
Co-Curricular and	Year 4+ (optional)	Generalise orchestration approach beyond examinations into co-curricular learning —

EduNeuro will not pursue broad expansion before establishing a solid foundation in its initial market.

Submitted by: Sumanta, Founder, EduNeuro

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